Recruitment System Operations Runbook

From Application Review to Appointment

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1 Purpose

This guide explains how to run recruitment after the installation has been completed.

The workspace is organised around the work administrators need to do. Start with the selected round, identify outstanding tasks, and complete each action through the interface.

Do not edit database snapshots to change outcomes.

2 Start of the Working Day

1. Open the recorded administrator link.
2. Sign in using the authorised account.
3. Confirm the active recruitment round.
4. Check pending reviews and communications.
5. Inspect unresolved delivery issues.
6. Confirm that published details remain correct.

The owner uses the private link. Additional staff use the public deployment's administrator page and an allowlisted email.

3 Workspace Map

Area	Use it for
Applications	Answers, evidence, checks and shortlisting
Interviews	Slots, bookings and assessments
Decisions	Offers, reservations and appointments
Communications	Message previews, release and delivery checks
Rounds & roles	Seasons, requirements and capacity
Settings	Owner controls and integration preferences

Staff access currently spans rounds. Reviewer names are not per-role access restrictions.

4 Step 1: Configure and Open a Round

In **Rounds & roles**:

1. create the round;
2. add approved roles;
3. configure dates, requirements and positions;
4. publish a role with a future deadline;
5. publish the round; and
6. copy its applicant link.

Use Receptionist / Assistant as the combined role where that matches the vacancy.

Templates are starting points. Check each role against its approved advert.

5 Step 2: Review an Application

Open **Applications** and select the record.

Before making a decision, check:

- candidate identity and role;
- submitted answers;
- supporting evidence;
- completed and missing checks; and
- the current stage.

Read and download the evidence through the authorised interface.

Record factual notes, complete the checks and save the review. A declared condition is not the same as verified evidence.

If information is missing, send a clear information request through the workflow.

6 Step 3: Shortlist and Release the Invitation

Shortlist after completing required checks and resolving eligibility.

Shortlisting prepares an invitation. It does not itself communicate the invitation.

1. Open **Communications**.
2. Inspect the recipient and message.
3. Confirm that it matches the current stage.
4. Release it.

The applicant can book after the invitation has been released.

7 Step 4: Create Interview Slots

In **Interviews**, enter:

- a future date and time;
- a duration between five and 180 minutes;
- panel members;
- an optional role restriction; and
- a location or HTTPS meeting link.

Use consistent panel names. Conflict checks depend on recognising the same panel member across slots.

If Calendar is enabled, inspect the owner's calendar after booking: `https://calendar.google.com/`

No guest invitations are created automatically.

8 Step 5: Record the Interview Assessment

Apply the approved assessment process.

Record a rating from one to five and relevant notes through the assessment action.

The rating does not automatically appoint the candidate. Continue through Decisions.

9 Step 6: Prepare the Offer

Before preparing an offer, confirm:

- evidence checks are complete;
- the assessment is recorded;
- a position is available; and
- the candidate has no competing active allocation in this round.

Preparing the offer reserves capacity and places alternative applications on hold.

An offer reservation is not an appointment.

10 Step 7: Release and Receive the Response

Preview and release the offer in **Communications**.

The candidate accepts or declines through their own portal.

If accepted, the record moves to accepted. If declined, the reservation is released and held alternatives reopen.

Unanswered offers do not automatically expire through a background job in this version. Escalate unresolved offers to the owner.

11 Step 8: Confirm Appointment

After acceptance and the required staff checks, confirm the appointment.

The system:

- records the appointed allocation;
- closes alternative applications in the round; and
- prepares an appointment message.

Review and release that message separately.

Do not issue a misleading regret for an alternative role when the person has been appointed elsewhere in the same round.

12 Step 9: Handle Other Outcomes

Record an unsuccessful outcome with an appropriate reason, or place an assessed candidate on the waiting list.

Preview the resulting messages before release.

An active offer or appointment needs to be resolved through the supported process before its outcome can be changed.

13 Step 10: Manage Communications

Release no more than thirty selected messages per batch.

Messages that cannot be sent because of quota remain pending. There is no automatic background sender.

For a **Check delivery** item:

1. inspect the sending account;
2. check the attempted message;
3. confirm only when supported by evidence; and
4. avoid creating an unnecessary duplicate.

A sent status does not prove that the recipient read the message.

References:

- `https://developers.google.com/apps-script/reference/mail/mail-app`
- `https://developers.google.com/apps-script/guides/services/quotas`

14 Step 11: Check Operational Limits

Plan intake around both Google quotas and the implementation's limits.

Constraint	**Action**
Login and recruitment share email quota	Monitor capacity before releases
Global login default: 50/day	Use a bounded pilot; code maximum is 200
Global login cap: 20/hour	Avoid a large simultaneous sign-in window
Global upload caps: 20/hour, 50/day	Plan intake and provide a support route
State size guard	Contact the maintainer before further intake
Broad administrator access	Keep the allowlist limited to trusted staff

Do not ask applicants to keep retrying when a cooldown or capacity limit has been reached.

15 Step 12: Resolve Corrections

For a stale administrator save:

1. refresh the workspace;
2. inspect the latest record; and
3. repeat only the action still required.

The owner can correct a verified applicant identifier with a reason before an active offer or appointment. The correction resets evidence checks.

Applicant edits from multiple tabs should be checked after saving because they do not have the same revision protection as administrator updates.

16 Step 13: Refresh Reports

Use **Settings > Refresh reports** to produce readable report tabs.

The reports are derived from the application state. Editing a report tab does not update the recruitment workflow.

Keep the Sheet, authentication data and evidence private.

17 Step 14: Close and Hand Over

Close the round to stop new applications.

Then reconcile:

- outstanding bookings;
- offers and reservations;
- appointments;
- pending or uncertain messages; and
- unresolved applicant cases.

Closing a round does not automatically delete its records or settle every outstanding action.

Pass on the configuration, support contact, deployment versions, unresolved cases and release records.

Retention must include evidence, reports and historical snapshots. Automatic deletion is not implemented.

18 Common Operational Problems

Problem	**What to check**
Cannot shortlist	Required checks and declared eligibility
Applicant cannot book	Released invitation and available slots
Cannot prepare an offer	Assessment, checks, capacity and existing allocation
Applicant cannot accept	The active offer has been released
A message remains pending	Quota, applicant URL and current outcome
Uncertain Calendar event	Inspect the owner's calendar before replacement
Missing report change	Refresh reports; do not edit snapshots

Execution history: `https://script.google.com/home/executions`

Troubleshooting: `https://developers.google.com/apps-script/guides/support/troubleshooting`

19 Administrator Feedback

After a small round, ask staff:

- Was the application easy to read?
- Could you identify its current stage?
- Was the next action clear?
- Could you find the required evidence?
- Did the workspace make the task feel manageable?
- Which steps still required repeated work?

Use that feedback alongside measured task times. Readability should be evaluated as part of the system's effectiveness, rather than treated only as visual presentation.